

Day 86 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in History & National Movement (6): India's 44th UNESCO World Heritage Site & Tentative List Expansion

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's most recent UNESCO World Heritage Site inscription and the expansion of India's UNESCO Tentative List.

Q: How many UNESCO World Heritage Sites does India have as of 2026, and how are they categorised?

A: 44 sites total — 36 cultural, 7 natural, and 1 mixed site — making India the 6th highest-ranked country globally for UNESCO sites.

Q: What was India's most recent UNESCO World Heritage Site inscription (2025), and what does it comprise?

A: The Maratha Military Landscapes — a network of 12 historic forts linked to the Maratha Empire, inscribed in 2025.

Q: Which site was inscribed in 2024, just before the Maratha Military Landscapes?

A: Assam's Moidams (the mound-burial system of the Ahom dynasty).

Q: What recent addition was made to India's UNESCO Tentative List, and what did it bring the total to?

A: 7 new natural heritage sites were added, raising India's Tentative List tally from 62 to 69. The 7 sites: Deccan Traps at Panchgani and Mahabaleshwar (Maharashtra), St. Mary's Island Cluster (Karnataka), Meghalayan Age Caves (Meghalaya), Naga Hill Ophiolite (Nagaland), Erra Matti Dibbalu (Andhra Pradesh), Natural Heritage of Tirumala Hills (Andhra Pradesh), and Varkala Cliffs (Kerala).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. As of 2026, India has how many UNESCO World Heritage Sites in total?

- A. 40
- B. 42
- C. 44 ✓**
- D. 46

Explanation: 44 (36 cultural, 7 natural, 1 mixed). [medium, web-research]

2. India's most recent (2025) UNESCO World Heritage Site inscription, the 'Maratha Military Landscapes', comprises how many historic forts?

- A. 8
- B. 10
- C. 12 ✓**
- D. 15

Explanation: 12 forts. [hard, web-research]

3. Which UNESCO site, inscribed in 2024, relates to the Ahom dynasty's mound-burial system?

- A. Moidams, Assam ✓**
- B. Khangchendzonga National Park
- C. Rani-ki-Vav
- D. Kaziranga National Park

Explanation: Moidams, Assam. [medium, web-research]

4. The recent addition of 7 new natural heritage sites raised India's UNESCO Tentative List total from 62 to:

- A. 65
- B. 67
- C. 69 ✓**
- D. 71

Explanation: 69. [hard, web-research]

5. India ranks where globally in total number of UNESCO World Heritage Sites?

- A. 3rd
- B. 4th

C. 5th

D. 6th ✓

Explanation: 6th highest-ranked. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Simple Interest

READING MATERIAL

Simple Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC favors word-problem variants (doubling time, comparing two loans, fractional rates with month-based time) over the bare 'calculate SI' formula alone.

Q: Formula: What is the Simple Interest formula, and how do you get the doubling time from it?

A: $SI = (\text{Principal} \times \text{Rate} \times \text{Time}) / 100$. A sum **DOUBLES** when SI equals the Principal itself: $P = (P \times R \times T) / 100 \rightarrow T = 100/R$ years. So at 8% per annum, doubling time = $100/8 = 12.5$ years = 150 months.

Q: Real exam (2024): In how many months will Rs.2,000 double itself at 8% per annum simple interest?

A: $T = 100/R = 100/8 = 12.5$ years = $12.5 \times 12 = 150$ months.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the simple interest on Rs.1,000 for one year at 10% per annum?

A: $SI = (1000 \times 10 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}100$.

Q: Real exam (2024): Find the simple interest on Rs.68,000 at $16\frac{2}{3}\%$ per annum for 9 months.

A: Convert the mixed-fraction rate: $16\frac{2}{3}\% = 50/3\%$. Convert months to years: 9 months = $9/12 = 3/4$ year. $SI = 68,000 \times (50/3) \times (3/4) / 100 = 68,000 \times 12.5/100 = \text{Rs.}8,500$. (The 3s cancel neatly between the rate's denominator and the time's numerator — recognizing that shortcut avoids messy fraction arithmetic.)

Q: Real exam (2025): A borrows Rs.16,000 at 12% p.a. simple interest, B borrows Rs.12,000 at 18% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed (principal+interest) become equal?

A: Set up the equality: $16000 + 16000(0.12)t = 12000 + 12000(0.18)t \rightarrow 16000 + 1920t = 12000 + 2160t \rightarrow 4000 = 240t \rightarrow t = 16\frac{2}{3}$ years.

Q: Method — finding the rate when given principal, time, and final amount: A sum of Rs.5,000 becomes Rs.6,200 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate.

A: $SI = \text{Amount} - \text{Principal} = 6200 - 5000 = 1200$. Rearranged formula: $R = (SI \times 100) / (P \times T) = (1200 \times 100) / (5000 \times 3) = 120000/15000 = 8\%$ per annum.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In how many years will a sum double itself at 5% per annum simple interest?

- A. 10 years
- B. 15 years
- C. 20 years ✓**
- D. 25 years

Explanation: $T = 100/R = 100/5 = 20$ years. [easy, authored]

2. Find the simple interest on Rs.2,500 for 1 year at 12% per annum.

- A. Rs.250
- B. Rs.275
- C. Rs.300 ✓**
- D. Rs.320

Explanation: $SI = (2500 \times 12 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}300$. [easy, authored]

3. Find the simple interest on Rs.54,000 at $13\frac{1}{3}\%$ per annum for 6 months.

- A. Rs.3,600 ✓**
- B. Rs.3,000
- C. Rs.3,300
- D. Rs.4,000

Explanation: $13\frac{1}{3}\% = 40/3\%$. 6 months = $1/2$ year. $SI = 54000 \times (40/3) \times (1/2) / 100 = 54000 \times 40/600 = 54000 \times (1/15) = 3,600$. [hard, authored]

4. C borrows Rs.20,000 at 10% p.a. simple interest, D borrows Rs.15,000 at 15% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed become equal?

- A. 8 years
- B. 10 years

C. 20 years ✓

D. 25 years

Explanation: $20000 + 2000t = 15000 + 2250t \rightarrow 5000 = 250t \rightarrow t = 20$ years. [hard, authored]

5. A sum of Rs.8,000 becomes Rs.9,440 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate per annum.

A. 5%

B. 6% ✓

C. 6.5%

D. 7%

Explanation: $SI = 9440 - 8000 = 1440$. $R = (1440 \times 100) / (8000 \times 3) = 144000 / 24000 = 6\%$. [medium, authored]

6. What sum will yield Rs.900 as simple interest in 3 years at 6% per annum?

A. Rs.4,000

B. Rs.5,000 ✓

C. Rs.5,500

D. Rs.6,000

Explanation: $P = (SI \times 100) / (R \times T) = (900 \times 100) / (6 \times 3) = 90000 / 18 = \text{Rs.}5,000$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poems: "Teamwork" & "Courage" — both by Edgar Albert Guest

READING MATERIAL

Both poems are short, didactic verse by the same American poet (Edgar Albert Guest, also responsible for "The Stick-Together Families" elsewhere in this syllabus). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests these almost entirely via 'identify the figure of speech in this exact line' and 'what does the pronoun it/this refer to' — so the Q&A below drills both formats directly.

Q: What is the central message of "Courage"?

A: The poem defines courage by first saying what it ISN'T (not a brilliant dash, not instantaneous, not born of despair, not a creature of flickered hope), then says what it IS: something deep in the soul of man, always working to serve a plan, present in both victory and defeat, and in every trial a person faces. This 'define by negation, then affirmation' structure is itself worth recognizing for appreciation-style questions.

Q: Real exam line: "It's written in victory and defeat, And every trial a man may meet." What does 'it' refer to?

A: Courage — this exact line, with this exact pronoun-reference question, appeared in a real TNPSC paper (2024).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Courage isn't a brilliant dash" and "But it's something deep in the soul of man."

A: Both lines are cited as Metaphor — courage is described AS a 'dash' / AS something physically 'deep' inside a person, without using 'like/as'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Born of despair with a sudden spring" and "It isn't a creature of flickered hope" and "That is working always to serve some plan."

A: All three are cited as Personification — courage (an abstract idea) is given creature-like or human-like qualities (being 'born', being a 'creature', 'working' toward a 'plan').

Q: What is the central message of "Teamwork"?

A: Individual fame and being 'singled out' for glory matter less than contributing to the team — 'there's no lone hand in the game we play.' True worth is shown by how you 'pull with the team' and work with your 'running mate' toward a 'bigger scheme', not by solo achievement.

Q: Real exam line: "It's helping your fellowman to score, When his chances hopeless seem." What does 'it' refer to?

A: Teamwork — this exact line, with this exact pronoun-reference question, appeared in a real TNPSC paper (2024).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "And it's fine to be counted a star" and "For there's no lone hand in the game we play" and "We must work to a bigger scheme."

A: All three are cited as Metaphor — being 'a star', having a 'lone hand' (a card-game image for going it alone), and a 'bigger scheme' are all non-literal stand-ins for the poem's real subject (individual glory vs. teamwork).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "It's all very well to have courage and skill" and "And the thing that counts in the world to-day."

A: Both lines are cited as Alliteration in the source material.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "How do you pull with the team?"

A: Synecdoche — 'pull' (a single physical action, as in rowing or tug-of-war) stands in for a person's entire contribution and effort within the team.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "They may single you out for fame."

A: Irony — cited as ironic given the poem's overall argument that individual fame/recognition is less meaningful than team contribution; being 'singled out' runs against the poem's central value.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "It's written in victory and defeat, And every trial a man may meet." The word 'it' in this real exam line refers to:

- A. Hope
- B. Sports
- C. Courage ✓**
- D. Patience

Explanation: Courage — confirmed real 2024 TNPSC question. [medium, question-bank-2024]

2. "It's helping your fellowman to score, When his chances hopeless seem." The word 'it' in this real exam line refers to:

- A. Hard work

- B. Best work
- C. Smart work
- D. Team work ✓**

Explanation: Teamwork — confirmed real 2024 TNPSC question. [medium, question-bank-2024]

3. Which figure of speech is used in "Courage isn't a brilliant dash"?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor ✓**
- C. Personification
- D. Alliteration

Explanation: Metaphor. [medium, web-research]

4. Which figure of speech is used in "Born of despair with a sudden spring"?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor
- C. Personification ✓**
- D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — courage is described as being 'born'. [medium, web-research]

5. Which figure of speech is used in "It isn't a creature of flickered hope"?

- A. Hyperbole
- B. Simile
- C. Metaphor
- D. Personification ✓**

Explanation: Personification — courage is called a 'creature'. [medium, web-research]

6. Which figure of speech is used in "For there's no lone hand in the game we play" (from Teamwork)?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor ✓**
- C. Irony
- D. Synecdoche

Explanation: Metaphor — 'lone hand' (a card-game image) stands for going it alone. [medium, web-research]

7. Which figure of speech is used in "How do you pull with the team?"

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor
- C. Irony
- D. Synecdoche ✓**

Explanation: Synecdoche — 'pull' represents the whole of a person's team contribution. [hard, web-research]

8. Which figure of speech is used in "They may single you out for fame"?

- A. Irony ✓**
- B. Metaphor
- C. Hyperbole
- D. Simile

Explanation: Irony — being singled out for individual fame runs against the poem's team-first message. [hard, web-research]

9. "And it's fine to be counted a star" uses which figure of speech?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor ✓**
- C. Hyperbole
- D. Alliteration

Explanation: Metaphor — 'a star' stands for being exceptionally accomplished. [medium, web-research]

10. Both "Teamwork" and "Courage" are written by:

- A. Robert Frost
- B. Edgar Albert Guest ✓**

C. Henry Van Dyke

D. Rudyard Kipling

Explanation: Edgar Albert Guest wrote both — and also 'The Stick-Together Families' elsewhere in this syllabus. [easy, web-research]